

The Monkey Festival

Reading text | Keep this page open while you answer the questions.

PART ONE

- A. I am at one of the most unusual festivals in the world - the Monkey Festival in Lopburi, Thailand. People are getting ready for the festival, so I finally have some time to write about my adventures.
- B. Everybody in town gets together and the entire town goes a little crazy on this day! Many people are dressed like monkeys, and the festival has live performances and dances.
- C. The first thing you notice when you look around town are the monkeys. They are everywhere! I can see a few of them right now. They are gathered together on the street corner, playing with each other and making loud noises.
- D. They may look cute, but you have to be careful. These monkeys can cause major trouble. They like to take things from people, especially food and drinks, and even valuable things, like handbags and sunglasses.
- E. This is an annual festival, and people look forward to it all year. Early in the morning, people prepare huge plates of fruit and put them on long tables. The tables look beautiful, but they aren't going to stay that way.
- F. The best part of the festival is when thousands of excited monkeys jump on the tables and eat as much fruit as they possibly can. I heard that sometimes the monkeys even have food fights! I hope they have one today. What a crazy festival!

PART TWO

- G. I also noticed the way the people of Lopburi treat the monkeys. They are kind to them and make sure that they are not hungry. In the beginning, I found this attitude a bit strange. Why would these people care so much about the monkeys? After all, they are quite scary and they often steal things.
- H. I asked my friend Aroon, who owns a small business in the center of town. He explained that the people of Lopburi admire the monkeys because of a famous story that happened many centuries ago. It is about Prince Rama and it tells how monkeys helped him save his wife from a horrible monster.
- I. They take care of the monkeys and once a year, every November, they honor them by having a monkey festival. They believe that these monkeys will bring them good luck, like they did for Prince Rama.

Reading support: unusual = not usual; annual = once a year; valuable = worth a lot; honor = show respect.

Source: the Grade 8 October test in the teacher's archive. Paragraph letters were added for practice.

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Independent work | Return to Zoom at 12:25. Submit by 12:40.

First name: _____ Class: _____

A. Reading - Answer in English. Add the paragraph letter.

1. When does the festival take place each year?

2. What do many people wear at the festival?

3. Name two valuable things that the monkeys take.

4. Why should visitors be careful around the monkeys?

5. Why do people believe the monkeys can bring them good luck?

B. Translation - Write these sentences in English.

1. אני בפסטיבל.

2. אני אוהב את הפסטיבל.

3. אני יכול להיות בפסטיבל.

C. Group 01 - Complete with: however / care

1. It was hard. _____, I tried.

2. The baby needs _____.

D. Optional challenge - Would you visit this festival? Write two sentences and use one detail from the text. Write on a separate page.

Before submitting: check your answers, paragraph letters, capital letters and full stops.